

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

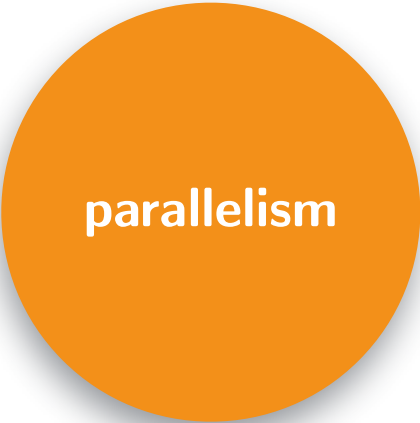
A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.

A third answer is: No.
Physical and phenomenal
properties cannot causally
interact.

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interactionism

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parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

Each of these views has its own strengths and weaknesses.

Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the
three views -- why would anyone hold it?

One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal connections between the physical and mental realms can look very puzzling.

Most philosophers who have accepted the distinctness of phenomenal and physical properties have not been parallelisms. Many have instead been interactionists, who can accept that the causal structure of reality is much as we take it to be.

ANN'S BLOOD SUGAR
FALLS BELOW 80
MG/DL

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

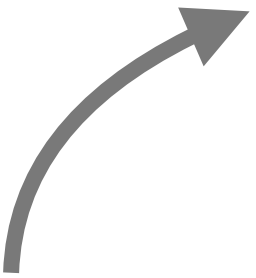
ANN WALKS TO THE
FRIDGE AND OPENS
THE DOOR

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

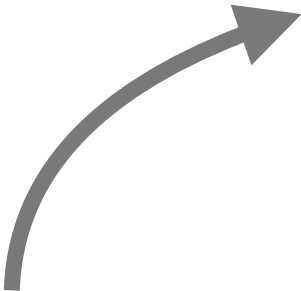
ANN REACHES OUT FOR THE
APPLE AND BRINGS IT TO
HER MOUTH AND TAKES A
BITE.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .











But interactionist brings with it a puzzle. It seems to show that the view of the physical world that we get from modern physical is radically incomplete.

According to contemporary physics, there are four fundamental forces:

gravity, electromagnetism, and the strong and weak nuclear forces.

To say that these are fundamental is to say that they cannot be explained in more basic terms. To say that there are just four is to say that all interactions between physical things can be explained in terms of just these forces.

But consider Ann's act of walking to the fridge. If interactionism is true, this event is a counterexample to this general claim.

If interactionism is true, such exceptions are happening all the time.

Imagine being a physicist in the universe of *Star Wars*, in which people can mentally make objects move by use of 'the force.' If you wanted a complete theory of the movement of physical objects, you could not stop with gravity, electromagnetism, and the strong and weak nuclear forces. You would have to posit a fifth fundamental **mental** force.

If interactionism is true, our world is in certain key respects similar to the universe of *Star Wars* in this way. This would be surprising!









phenomenal properties can

causaphenomenal

One answer is: Yes.

causal/physical properties.

Physical properties can

properties, and

causal phenomena

properties cannot cause

properties; but phenomena

physical properties.

Physical properties can

A second answer is: Yes.



interact.

properties cannot causally

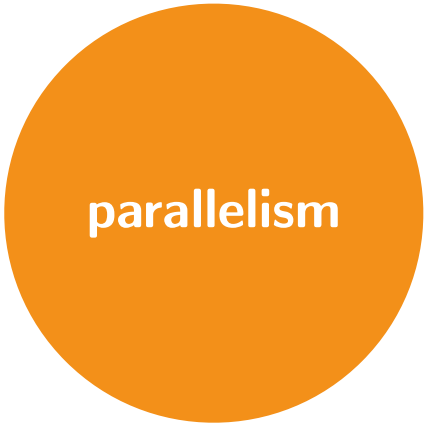
Physical and phenomenal



A third answer is: No.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the entire image. Centered within this circle is the word "parallelism" in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font.

parallelism



epi-

phenomenalism

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interactionism

epi-

phenomenalism